

Lesson 8: My Help Map



Identify your personal support system.

 In this activity, you will identify and map out the trusted people and resources you can reach out to for support regarding substance use concerns.



Key terms

Term	Definition
Substance	A chemical or physical material that affects how the body and brain function.
Support Network	A group of trusted people you can rely on for help and guidance.
Trusted Adult	An adult who listens, stays calm, and helps keep you safe.
Community Resources	Professional services or organizations that provide help to people in need.



Read and Learn About Help

Read the following passage carefully. As you read, ask yourself: **Why is it important to have more than one person on your personal help map?**

Everyone faces challenges, and it is important to know that you do not have to handle them alone. If you or someone you know has concerns about substance use, the best first step is to talk to someone you trust.

Your support network can include people from different parts of your life. This might be a teacher at school, a family member at home, or a counselor in your community. Having a variety of people to choose from ensures you can find help when you need it most.

When you create your help map, think about who makes you feel safe, heard, and supported. Whether it is an emergency or just a question, knowing exactly who to call or visit helps you take quick, healthy action to keep yourself and your friends safe.



Think, Pair, Share

Answer the questions below by yourself. Then, talk with a partner and write down their thoughts in the space provided.

Question	Your Answer	Your Partner's Answer
What are three different types of people or places you can add to your personal help map for support?		
Why is it helpful to include people from both your school and your home in your personal support plan?		
If you were in an emergency situation, how does having a pre-planned support map help you make better decisions?		

Prepare what you and your partner will share. **What was similar, different, or noteworthy about your answers?**

We noticed that...

My Personal Help Map

Use this list to organize your own network.

- Trusted adult at school: _____
- Trusted adult at home: _____
- Friend or peer support: _____
- Community support: _____
- Emergency support: _____